Here are two more incidents that exposed the sabotage of police reforms by bureaucrats as I saw them.

First, on 11 January 2007, I was present in the Supreme Court of India to listen to the judgement of Chief Justice Y. K. Sabharwal on the petition on police reforms filed by Prakash Singh, former DGP, and others against the Union of India and others (writ petition, civil, no. 310, 1996). I was the only serving officer who dared to be present in the court. I went particularly to witness history in the making with regard to police reforms. I regret to say that I did not see any other serving officer present in the court, more so when Delhi overflows with police leaders, to hear what was to become a career-altering judgement. Because, on this day, the state governments and the Government of India were to be present to plead against the apex court's judgement of 26 September 2006 (as was decided by them in the earlier meeting with the home secretary). There was a battery of advocates (see Appendix 3), representing almost all the states of the country, including the seniormost counsel from the Government of India. I saw one senior advocate after another standing up and pleading against one or many directions on police reforms given in the earlier judgement of 26 September 2006. This included the legal counsel from my own Delhi Police with a brief against police reforms. This left me astounded because at that time I was hoping to return to my force (Delhi Police) and implement the directions of the apex court.

I saw and heard the apex court dictate: '…we cannot permit review of our judgement and order dated 26 September 2006' (for more details, see Appendix 3).

As soon as the proceedings were over, Prakash Singh, the appellant, and I stepped out of the court. Both of us were swamped by the media covering the case. I expressed my exhilaration and relief on the decision of the court. I thereafter went back to my office. A few hours later, I was to attend a meeting with my boss, the Union home secretary. The news of the judgement was being telecast. And it happened to become a topic of discussion in the same meeting. The home secretary asked for a clarification about the judgement from certain other colleagues sitting around his table. Since all of them had only secondhand information, it was factually incorrect. I merely clarified for the benefit of all present. Instead of appreciating the correction, the home secretary turned around and asked me, seething with anger: '*What were you doing in the court? Was there no work for you in the BPRD today*?' I understood the reason for his discomfort at the judgement. I wryly smiled and said: '*Sir, you forget that I am the DGP, Bureau of Police Research and Development (BPRD) and police reforms fall within my area of responsibility.'* He got this retort from me in the presence of many other colleagues of his. I only saw him fuming and not knowing what further to say. He yet again revealed his inner aversion to police reforms and the changes that could come about in the police functioning, which he and his predecessors had all along been stalling by sitting on the recommendations of the National Police Commission and other reports ever since India got independence.

Second, in the judgement of the apex court, there was a directive to my organization (BPRD) to examine and report to the court within a declared time frame (four months) to list out crimes that were considered a threat to internal security and ought to be investigated by the Central Bureau of Investigation. Accordingly, we called for a meeting with state police representatives. Interestingly, just before I was to proceed to chair and conduct the meeting, the aforementioned home secretary took the trouble to come to my office only to tell me, as I recall: '*You will not discuss the judgement. Only stick to what has been asked.*' I asked: *'Why Sir? What is there to be kept back since it is a part of the same order and has to be seen in the light of police reforms directives?*' To which he replied: '*You just do what you are told to do.*' On this, I committed nothing to him. I did what was needed to be done. But I could see yet again the insecurities the man was suffering from.